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Jar for the wine offering, libation vessel

4.4.10 Jar for the wine offering, libation vessel

References:

Hebrew מְנַקִּית (mnaqith) EXO 25:29, EXO 37:16, NUM 4:7, JER 52:19

Hebrew קַשְׁוָה (qaswah) EXO 25:29, EXO 37:16, NUM 4:7, 1CH 28:17

Description and usage:

A ceramic figure with a libation jar (© Mary Harrsch from Springfield, Oregon, USA, CC BY 2.0, via Wikimedia Commons)The libation in the Tabernacle and Temple was the pouring out of wine as an offering to God. Two vessels were involved in this operation. From the first vessel the wine was poured into the second one. Both vessels were placed on the table for consecrated bread (see 4.3.5 Table for consecrated bread<REALIA:4.3.5>) and are only mentioned in connection with that table. The first container was a kind of jar or pitcher (*qaswah* in Hebrew), and the second one was a small bowl (*mnaqith* in Hebrew). Both objects were made of gold.

Translation:

EXO 25:29; EXO 37:16; NUM 4:7: In these passages the Hebrew words *mnaqith* and *qaswah* occur together with a verb that normally carries the meaning of "pouring out as a drink offering." According to Jewish tradition, an alternate rendering of this word would define the two objects as part of a frame for covering and protecting the bread of God's presence. In EXO 25:29 b such a rendering would be something like "the rods and the side frames with which to cover them," where RSV has "its flagons and bowls with which to pour libations." However, no translation consulted (not even NJPSV) reflects this.